

Parliament negotiators meet on transport budget

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【要点】

- ・ 欧州議会交渉担当者が本日、EU次期コネクティングヨーロッパ・ファシリティの妥協案テキストを承認するため会合を開き、予算規定と技術的問題について協議する予定である。
- ・ 妥協案では「EU優先」条項を導入し、戦略的に重要な輸送・エネルギー・防衛プロジェクトについてEU資金がヨーロッパのテクノロジーとサプライヤーを優遇でき、高リスク供給業者の参加を制限する。
- ・ 「使用しなければ失う」原則を導入し、実施マイルストーンを達成しないプロジェクトから資金を回収して、より成熟したスキームに再配分する仕組みを設ける。
- ・ 輸送プロジェクトのEU共同融資率を50%から60%に引き上げ、越境プロジェクトと低所得加盟国ではさらに高い率を適用する。
- ・ 鉄道・港湾・防衛関連の支援を拡大し、陸運から鉄道への転換を促進するとともに、港湾の岸上電力供給インフラや軍事動員回廊への投資を強化する。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By TOMMASO LECCA with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — European Parli

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SNEAK PEEK

— European Parliament negotiators meet today to endorse the latest compromise texts on the EU's next Connecting Europe Facility.

— MEPs' starting positions on various automotive files remain unchanged despite the sector bleeding jobs.

— The Commission launched two consultations on drones and electric vertical take-off and landing aircraft as part of its review of the Drone Strategy 2.0.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

MEPS TO DISCUSS CEF COMPROMISE: European Parliament negotiators meet today to endorse the latest draft compromise texts on the EU's next Connecting Europe Facility. According to the agenda, seen by Martina, negotiators are expected to discuss the compromise articles agreed at technical level — including the budget provisions and annexes — before discussing the remaining political issues in Annex I and giving technical teams a mandate to continue negotiations on evaluation and implementation rules.

Buy European: The compromise text, also obtained by Martina, introduces a new “Union preference” provision allowing EU funding to favor European technologies and suppliers for strategically important transport, energy and military mobility projects where justified by security or resilience concerns. It also proposes restricting the participation of high-risk suppliers in CEF-funded projects and reducing strategic dependencies on third-country supply chains, reflecting the EU's broader push to strengthen industrial resilience.

Use it or lose it: Parliament also wants to introduce a “use it or lose it” principle, allowing funding to be withdrawn from projects that fail to meet agreed implementation milestones without justification. The cash would then be reallocated to more mature schemes. The compromise also proposes increasing EU co-financing rates for transport projects, raising the maximum contribution from 50 percent to 60 percent, with even higher rates for cross-border projects and lower-income member states.

Rail, ports and defense: The draft expands support for rail-road terminals, logistics platforms, multimodal passenger hubs, urban nodes and last-mile connections while explicitly promoting combined transport to encourage a shift from road to rail. It also strengthens support for ports by funding onshore power supply, electricity grids, substations, energy storage and renewable generation, alongside greater investment in military mobility corridors, dual-use infrastructure and digital transport systems such as ERTMS.

CARS

DEBATE ON CAR POLICY UNCHANGED AS SECTOR CUTS JOBS: Volkswagen wants to lay off 100,000 workers and shutter four plants, yet the talking points from the left and right in the European Parliament remain unchanged. At a sector event Tuesday evening, the Socialists and Democrats and Renew continued to push for European preference requirements and maintaining existing emission targets, while the European People's Party beat the drum for all powertrains to be allowed on European roads.

State of play: The EU institutions are negotiating a package that will determine where Europe's cars are built, what kind of models are available and how quickly the sector will have to electrify. The Commission watered down the emission targets that automakers must hit or face fines, but the flexibility comes with Made in Europe requirements that are still being negotiated as part of the Industrial Accelerator Act.

Blame China: The one thing all of the speakers agreed on is the source of Europe's industrial woes: China and its speed at developing both electric vehicles and batteries with its control of the raw material supply chain.

Get it together: The onus is on automakers to make cars that are globally competitive — and they need to make the investments to make that a reality, said French MEP Christophe Grudler with Renew. “I will not hear anymore that the Chinese cars are better than ours,” he said. “You need to produce the best

cars in the world.”

Hush on layoffs: The debate skirted the job cuts and dismal economic performance of Germany’s automakers, including BMW, which recently revised down its financial prospects for this year.

COMMISSION TO LAUNCH RESKILLING PILOT PROGRAM: Brussels’ answer to Europe’s industrial upheaval: retrain workers before they get fired. Commission Executive Vice President Roxana Mînzatu today unveils the participants of the EU’s Skills Guarantee pilot projects.

Das Auto: The Commission will distribute €14 million among six projects in 10 EU countries focused on automotive workers whose jobs are at risk, a Commission official familiar with the plans but not authorized to speak on the record told our colleague Zoya Sheftalovich.

Grim backdrop: The Commission promised to dedicate more resources to reskilling in last year’s Automotive Action Plan. Suppliers were already cutting jobs, and the layoffs are getting worse with VW’s announcement.

How it’ll work: The idea is to move people into new roles through targeted reskilling and upskilling before they lose their jobs, rather than helping them afterward. The projects will run until 2028, with their results feeding into a skills guarantee under the EU’s future Competitiveness Fund.

RAIL

RAIL SECTOR PUSHES FOR BIGGER ROLE IN ETS REVIEW: Europe’s rail industry is urging the Commission to give rail a more prominent place in the upcoming overhaul of the EU Emissions Trading System, arguing that the sector already pays significant indirect carbon costs while delivering the bloc’s cleanest form of motorized transport, according to a letter seen by Martina.

The pitch: In the letter sent Tuesday to the cabinets of Climate Commissioner Wopke Hoekstra, Transport Commissioner Apostolos Tzitzikostas and Executive Vice President Teresa Ribera, rail lobby CER says electrified rail already bears the cost of the ETS through electricity prices, estimating the annual burden at around €571 million, rising to more than €790 million by 2027 if carbon prices increase as expected.

Reward rail: CER wants Brussels to recognize rail’s contribution to carbon avoidance under the ETS and earmark a larger, more predictable share of ETS revenues for rail infrastructure, rolling stock and projects that encourage passengers and freight to shift from road and air to rail.

The argument: The association says a European high-speed rail network built to the sector’s 2050 ambitions could avoid up to 5 billion metric tons of CO₂ by 2070 and generate more than €525 billion in carbon value at projected ETS prices, strengthening the case for using carbon market revenues to finance rail investment.

AVIATION

COMMISSION OPENS CONSULTATIONS ON DRONES AND EVTOLS: The Commission’s DG MOVE on Tuesday launched two consultations on drones and electric vertical take-off and landing aircraft as part of its review of the Drone Strategy 2.0.

The strategy, adopted in 2022, aimed to develop a European drone market and enable large-scale commercial drone operations in areas such as emergency services, mapping, inspection, surveillance and the urgent delivery of small consignments, including biological samples and medicines.

Flying taxi dream: The strategy also sought to foster air mobility services, such as air taxis, with the ambition of eventually integrating them into regular passenger transport. When the strategy was unveiled, air taxi developers and French authorities were still optimistic that flying taxis would be operating during the Paris 2024 Olympic Games — a vision that ultimately proved far too ambitious .

Keeping respondents separate: The two consultations, open from Tuesday until Sept. 6, target different audiences. One is addressed to the general public, while the other is aimed at manufacturers, operators, service providers, financial institutions and public authorities. The Commission wants to hear from people about the benefits, concerns and expectations they associate with drones and their role in society.

Operators and lobbies, meanwhile, are invited to share their views on the implementation of Drone Strategy 2.0, taking into account recent market, technological, regulatory and policy developments, as well as emerging challenges and opportunities. The results of both consultations will feed into a study that will be carried out by consulting firm EY.

EASA KEEPS ADVISING AIRLINES TO AVOID GULF AIRSPACE: The EU Aviation Safety Agency on Tuesday issued a new Conflict Zone Information Bulletin advising airlines not to operate within the airspace of Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, the United Arab Emirates, or parts of the Gulf of Oman. Unlike the now-withdrawn bulletin issued when the U.S.-Israeli campaign against Iran began, the new bulletin separates those five countries from the airspace over Iran and Iraq , which EASA also continues to advise airlines to avoid.

According to EASA, "Iranian efforts to maintain control over the Strait of Hormuz, recurrent attacks against commercial vessels, and related U.S. military actions create high risks for the airspace of Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar and the United Arab Emirates, as well as for the airspace over the waters in the Gulf of Oman."

The five countries "may be directly exposed to Iranian missile and drone attacks. The surrounding maritime airspace may also be affected by missile or drone overflights, interception activity, falling debris and the wider consequences of regional military escalation," the bulletin adds.

"Unpredictable military developments, combined with the possible use of missiles, drones, combat aircraft and air-defence systems, create a high risk to civil flights at all altitudes and flight levels within the concerned airspace," EASA said. The bulletin is currently due to remain in force until July 29.

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

No end in sight for new Iran war

There was little hope in the region for a swift resolution to the fighting as the two sides remain unable to resolve control of the Strait of Hormuz.

By Nahal Toosi, Paul McLeary, Megan Messerly · Jul 15, 2026, 12:16 am Europe/Brussels CEST

Trump backtracks on plan to charge 20 percent fee for ships traveling through Strait of Hormuz

The status of the critical waterway has roiled the U.S.-Iran war.

By Cheyanne M. Daniels · Jul 14, 2026, 06:00 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: Parliament seeks bigger transport budget, 'Buy European' rules

By Martina Sapio · Jul 14, 2026, 05:45 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Saving Europe's steel strains critical friendships abroad

In sharply curbing EU steel imports, Brussels tested relationships with the very trading partners it needs to counter China and the United States.

By Koen Verhelst · Jul 14, 2026, 03:21 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU Commission mulls tweaks to Foreign Subsidies Regulation

Three-year review finds that the measure is broadly "fit for purpose."

By Francesca Micheletti · Jul 14, 2026, 12:35 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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